



Basket Note Pads

Linux users can now store your tidbits in a “basket” of their own

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Basket Note Pads (<http://basket.kde.org>) is another note-taking software just like Tomboy. It can be installed on Gnome-based distributions as well, but requires additional KDE libraries in order to work. Compared to Tomboy, Basket Note Pads is a monster with many more features for security and also seamless integration with other applications.

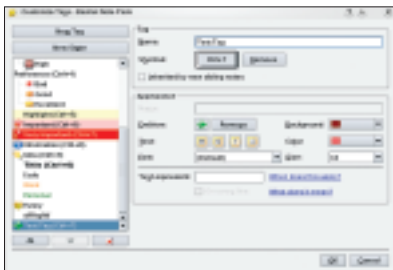
Creating Baskets

Notes are kept in baskets—a fancy name for container—that help in sorting and categorising events and tasks. You can create baskets by clicking on the Basket menu and then on **New > New Basket**. You can choose the layout template for this new basket.

You can make even more changes in the basket by right-clicking on a basket and choosing **Properties**. Tasks are created by clicking in a basket. Enter the notes and then click elsewhere.

Setting A Tag To The Note

Basket Note Pads is a complete note taking software and doubles as a planner at the same time. Every single note created can be changed to be a different kind of item. Say you create a new note. You can set that note to be an item in a To-Do list or you can use the note as a progress bar to monitor status of a particular job.



Setting a tag to the note

To change the note to any other kind item, click on the down arrow marker on the note and choose the type of tag you want to set. You can choose to set multiple tags to a note. There are also shortcut keys displayed alongside the tags.

You can also create your own tag or even customise an existing one. In the **Tags** menu, select **Assign New Tag**. Give the tag a name and choose a shortcut for it. Modify it further by setting different fonts, colours and icons for it.

You can prioritise tasks in the same manner. Select a task and use the dropdown menu for the task and select the priority level.

Add Elements To A Note

The speciality of Basket Note Pads is that you can simply drag elements into a note or basket. To drag images for example, open a file browser and drag and drop the image from the browser to the basket. Click on **Copy** here to confirm the move. To move the image in place, click on the left holder and drag it into place. Images can be locked to other text notes by dragging it below another note. To resize the image, hold the right holder and drag it.

There might be pages and sites with multiple little components that cannot be imported into Basket Note Pads. For this, there is even a screen capture feature which allows you to take a snapshot of the page and save it in the application. To do this, right-click in the basket and click on **Grab Screen Zone**. Drag a box around the area of interest, to capture the screen and to add it as an image in the basket.

Adding Links

It isn't just images and text that can be added to your notes. You can create links to sites and even

start programs by clicking on a link. To add a link to a program, select **Insert > Launcher**. Enter a command name for the application or press the **...** button to select a program. Give a name to the application and choose an icon. Click **OK**. Entering site links is simpler. Simply type the URL for the page in the note, and the link will be generated automatically.

Setting A Password

The notes in your basket may contain sensitive information. Right-click on a basket and select **Password**. Click on **Protect basket with a password**. Click **OK** and then enter a passphrase. You might have to repeat it a couple of times before it is registered. The next time you access this notebook, you will need to enter the password.

Filtering Notes

Searching notes in Basket Note Pads is of no worry either. You can search through the notes using the filter toolbar above the notebook workspace. Click on the **Tag** dropdown and then enter a keyword in the **Filter** text field. Even with no keyword entered, you can use the **Tag** dropdown menu to sort out a particular kind of note—for example, To Do lists or jobs of a particular priority level.

Importing And Backing Up Data

All notes need to be periodically backed up, to prevent data loss while migrating to another computer or account. Go to **Basket > Backup & Restore**. Move to **Another Folder** changes the location of your data files as per your choice. Backups can be made by clicking the **Backup...** button and the **Restore & Backup** can be used to restore backed up data. ■

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